Let’s Build an App

Before we start talking about front-end structure, we need to have an app to attach all that front-end structure to. I’ve created a sample website for a fictional music festival called North By, where multiple bands will perform at various concerts during the event. This app contains a schedule of all the concerts and venues. There isn’t much to this app. I used Rails scaffolding for a minimal amount of administration, but it’s just a structure that lets us get at the two pages we’ll be managing in this book: the schedule page and the concert display page.

The schedule page shows all the concerts, acts, and times for the entire festival. We’ll be adding features to this for inline editing, date filters, and search. We’ll let users list favorite concerts, and eventually we’ll show up-to-date information on how many tickets have been purchased.

The concert page shows you a simplified theater diagram for each concert and lets you select seats for a simulated ticket purchase. On this page, users can select seats and see their subtotal increase, or search for a block of seats and see which seats are available.

The data model for the app looks like this:

- The festival includes several concerts that take place at particular start times.
- Each concert has a venue, and each venue has a number of rows and a number of seats per row (which I realize is vastly simplified from real music venues, but we’re just going to pretend for now, because that gets very complicated very quickly).
- Each concert has one or more gigs that make up the concert.
- Each gig matches a band to a concert, and has a start order and a duration.
- Each concert has a bunch of sold tickets, which link a concert to a particular